his last sufferings by a tonic prepared from pomegranate rinds'.[25] 'He told me repeatedly he wished and even prayed for death,' wrote Lawrence. 'He said, sleeping and waking, the horrors of that dreadful retreat were always before his eyes. We all felt deeply for him and tried to soothe and comfort the old man, but it was of no avail, as he was worn out in body and mind, and evidently heart-broken by what had occurred. His wound remained unhealed, but he heeded it not; his anguish of mind was too intense to be distracted even by bodily suffering?. . .'[26]

On his last night, Elphinstone requested Moore to bring him a bowl of water and a clean shirt. Once washed and changed, he had Mackenzie read the prayers for the dying, and asked the weeping Moore to lift his head. 'I lay down on the bare floor near the poor General,' wrote Lawrence.

> [He] never appeared to close his eyes all night, so great was the pain he suffered.
>
> I spoke several times to him, but he only thanked me, saying I could do nothing for him, and that all must soon be over . . . His suffering had been intense, but he bore all with fortitude and resignation. He repeatedly expressed to me deep regret that he had not fallen in the retreat. His kind, mild disposition and courteous detachment had made him esteemed by us all, and we could not but regret his removal from amongst us, although his death was to him a most happy release.[27]

When he learned of the General's death, Akbar Khan chivalrously gave orders that the body should be conveyed down to Jalalabad, escorted by Moore. But it was Elphinstone's fate to suffer bad luck even in death. On the way down, a passing party of ghazis discovered what was being carried, opened the casket, then stripped the General's body naked and pelted it with stones. Akbar sent a second party of horsemen to rescue the corpse, and its guardian, and then had both rafted down the Kabul River to the gates of Jalalabad.

There, on 30 April, the ill-fated General was finally laid to rest by Pollock and Sale, with full military honours.[mm]

When news arrived in Kabul of the complete defeat of Akbar Khan, and as his wounded and battered troops began limping in on the evening of 8 April, there was a widespread panic, and many supporters of the Barakzai began to flee for the hills.[28]

Fatteh Jang and the Sadozai princes who had remained nervously holed up within the Bala Hisar since the death of Shah Shuja now found their